[TITLE]

[OWNER: full name] · San Francisco · a concept for Amsterdam Light Festival, Edition 16

The work

A globe two metres across, drawn in light: an armillary sphere of the Earth, made of colour.

It is made of six discs of cast acrylic, each tinted all the way through in one colour:

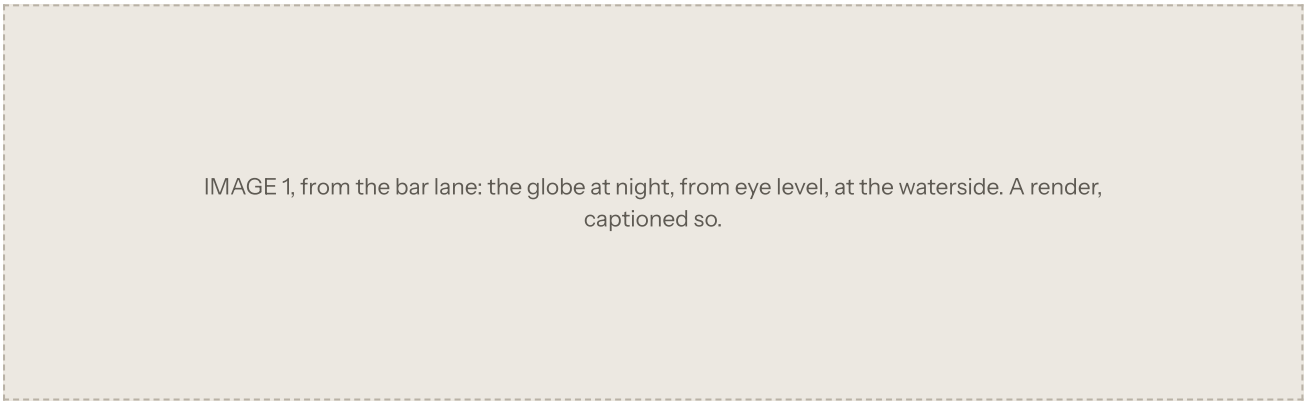
- **Three meridians**, in green, orange and violet, stand on edge and cross at the poles.
- **Three parallels**, in red, blue and yellow, ring them at the equator and at forty degrees north and south.

The discs are slotted into one another and bonded clear where they cross, so the globe is open: you see through it, and through one colour into the next. Its axis leans 23.4 degrees, as the Earth's does.

By day it is a piece of coloured glass the size of a small room. The sun goes through each disc and throws its colour on the ground, and where two discs cross the colours mix.

At night the rims glow. Cast acrylic carries light along a disc the way a fibre does, so light fed into an edge leaves at the polished rims while the faces stay dark and clear [bar lane: how the light enters the discs, as proofed]. Six lines of colour, each the circle of its disc, draw the globe in the air. One hard spot, low across the quay, throws the globe's shadow: rings inside rings, each in its own colour, laid over the paving and the water.

There's no screen, no projection and no moving part. The light is steady, and the work is the material doing what it does: one object, drawn three times, in its rims, on the quay and in the canal.



The idea

[THEME: Edition 16's theme, from the artist briefing. One paragraph that reads the work through it, written once the theme is known. Hold to what the work is: a model of the planet you can stand inside the light of, made from one material in six colours.]

A globe is the oldest way of holding the whole world in front of you. Most globes are solid: a surface of countries with nothing inside. This one is only lines, the meridians and the parallels, the grid we drew on the planet to find our way around it. With the surface gone, the light is what's left, and you can look straight through the world to the city on the other side.

Each line is its own colour, and none is the "right" one. Walk round it, and the colours in front pass over the ones behind and mix, so the globe changes with every step.

[OWNER: one or two sentences of your own: why a globe, and why light that comes from inside the material rather than being shone onto it. Keep it in your voice; the jury reads this for "relation to the artist statement".]

How the public meets it

- **From a distance.** On the canal route, the globe reads first as six coloured circles hanging in the dark, from a boat or from the far quay. Water doubles it: every rim is drawn a second time, broken up, on the canal below.
- **Close to.** The globe stands at the waterside on a low plinth, its lowest point about [0.5] m above the ground, so people can walk round it and look up through it. The polished edges are lit; the faces are cool and clear.
- **Through it.** Stand on the far side and the city appears through the discs, tinted: a bridge in yellow, a facade in violet. Phones will do the rest: the picture everyone takes is the city framed by the world.

- **Its shadow.** The spot lays the globe flat on the quay in coloured rings, long and low. Walking through it puts the colours on your coat, and the rings ride on the canal's surface beyond. By day, the low winter sun does the same.
- **For everyone.** It's silent and steady: no flashing, no strobe, nothing that startles. The light level is [to be set with the festival's technicians] for the site, so it sits among the canal's own lights rather than over them.


IMAGE 2, from the bar lane: the hard spot's coloured shadow on the quay and the water. A render, captioned so.

Materials and making

- **The discs.** Cell-cast acrylic sheet, [25] mm thick, tinted through in six colours, each disc cut flat (in segments where the sheet is narrower than the disc) and joined with a clear polymerising cement. The edges are diamond-polished, because the rims are what glows.
- **The light.** Low-voltage LEDs, [24] V, sealed (IP67) and fed into each disc's edge inside the base and at the joints, warm enough to show each colour truly. The drivers sit in the plinth, away from water, [on a timer set to the festival's hours]. Estimated draw: [W, from the bar lane's sheet], about the same as [comparison, from the sheet].
- **The structure.** A [steel or aluminium] armature inside the plinth holds the globe at its lowest point and at [the axis]. The plinth is ballasted to the engineer's figure for the site's wind, so nothing is drilled into the quay unless the festival prefers it.
- **Made in.** [OWNER: where the sheet is cast and the discs are cut and joined; the bar lane's sheet names the shops.]


IMAGE 3, from the bar lane: the technical drawing: plan, elevation, the plinth and its ballast, dimensions.

Two months outdoors

The work is built for an Amsterdam winter, from late November to mid-January, and the plan answers each risk.

Risk	The answer
Rain, frost, damp	Acrylic doesn't rust or rot, and takes up only a little water. The LEDs and their connections are sealed to IP67; the drivers are in the plinth, raised off the ground, with drainage
Wind	The open globe offers far less face to the wind than a solid sphere of its size. The plinth is ballasted to a structural engineer's calculation for the site, and the engineer signs it off [bar lane: stamped sheet]
Cold, damp and movement	Acrylic moves more than metal: about 0.07 mm per metre for each degree, and a little more as it takes up damp. Every fixing between acrylic and metal floats in a slotted hole with a soft gasket, so the discs can move without stress

Colour over time	The discs are cut flat, not heat-formed, from colour-stable cast sheet. The maker's colour guarantee covers flat sheet outdoors (it doesn't cover sheet that has been formed), and two months is well within it
Knocks and climbing	Cast acrylic is far tougher than glass and doesn't break into shards. The globe's lowest point is out of easy reach for climbing, and the plinth has no footholds. A spare disc segment of each colour travels with the work
Cleaning	Water and a mild soap only, never solvents or glass sprays, which craze acrylic. A cleaning sheet goes to the festival's crew
Nuisance	None: no sound, no smoke, no lasers, no flashing. The light points inward and along the discs, not out at the windows of the neighbours
Fire	Acrylic is combustible. The LEDs run cool, the drivers are fused and outside the acrylic, and the electrical work follows the festival's technical rules [bar lane: the electrical note]

Installing and removing. The globe arrives in [N] crated parts: the plinth with its ballast, then the globe, pre-assembled or in [two] halves. Installation takes [one day with a small crane or a boom lift] and a crew of [four]; removal is the reverse, and leaves nothing behind.

In brief

Title	[TITLE]
Maker	[OWNER: full name], San Francisco
Size	About 2 m across on a plinth about [0.5] m high; about [245–485] kg before ballast, under study [bar lane's sheet]
Material	Cell-cast acrylic, tinted through in six colours; a ballasted [steel] plinth
Light	Low-voltage sealed LEDs, edge-fed, and one hard spot for the shadow; [W]
New or existing	New: made for the festival, at 2 m. A [1.25] m version is [planned / built] [OWNER]
Budget	[From the bar lane's budget: production, transport, installation]